



Vendor Information Packet

NOLA LabFest 2026 | A Lab Innovation Summit

Thank you for joining us as a sponsor at NOLA LabFest. This packet covers the key logistics, deadlines and on-site details you'll need to prepare for the event.

The LabFest difference

You'll be with participating labs and the Nowak team throughout the event—not tucked away in a separate vendor room. You're invited to attend the sessions and evening events, with dedicated table time built in. The real value is the networking, so plan to be part of the full experience.

Event at a Glance

Event dates	October 15–17, 2026
Location	Hilton New Orleans Riverside, Two Poydras Street, New Orleans, LA 70130
Event space	Churchill Ballroom
Vendor setup	Thursday, October 15 10:00 AM–5:00 PM
Teardown	Saturday, October 17 after 3:00 PM
Expected attendance	150–200 attendees approximately 35 vendors

Hotel & Travel

When should I arrive?

We encourage arrival on Wednesday, October 14, or the morning of Thursday, October 15, to allow time for setup and the Seven Three Distillery event Thursday evening.

Hotel booking link

<https://book.passkey.com/e/51212951>

Booking deadline and rate

September 15 | \$239 per night

Parking and airport access

Valet and nearby self-parking are available. The hotel is approximately a 20-minute ride from the airport.

Your LabFest Experience

The FREE NOLA LabFest App 🥳

New this year, the free NOLA LabFest app will serve as your event guidebook. It will include:

- The agenda
- Badge scanner (scan the attendee badge, make a note and download at the end of the show)**
- Interactive vendor map with links to vendor websites
- Schedule
- Photo sharing
 - Attendees will use the vendor passport to engage with booths.
 - The interactive map will also allow attendees to vote for the best-decorated booth.

Your LabFest App Download Instructions:

Website: app.nolalabfest.com

Put the app on your phone screen

- iPhone: open the link in Safari, tap Share, then Add to Home Screen
- Android: open it in Chrome, tap the three dots, then Install App
- Open it from that icon from then on
- On a computer, same link, then click the install icon in the address bar

Sign in

- Email: the one this packet came to
- **Password:** Labfest26, and you will pick your own right away

Set up your booth (My Account, then My Booth)

- Add your logo, description, categories, website and contact
- Everyone from your company shares the booth and sees the same leads
- Booth numbers say TBD until we finish the floor plan

Scan leads at the show (tap Scan)

- Point your phone at an attendee badge
- Add a note while you are still talking to them
- Export the whole list to a spreadsheet when the show ends

The passport game

- Attendees scan the printed QR sign at your booth to earn prize entries
- Keep the sign visible. It brings people to your table.

App Questions: brandi@nowakdental.com

Booth Décor Contest

We'd love to see every booth lean into the Mardi Gras theme. **The best-decorated booth will receive a 50% discount** on its booth for next year's LabFest.

Make it memorable

Bring the Mardi Gras energy. Creative, photo-worthy booths will help drive traffic and give you a shot at next year's discount.

Shipping & Receiving

When should materials arrive?

Plan for packages to arrive 3–4 days before the event.

Where can I find shipping instructions?

See the Hilton Riverside New Orleans FedEx Office Shipping Instructions included at the end of this packet.

Can the hotel store early shipments?

Storage is available subject to the FedEx Office policies and fees shown in the shipping instructions.

Are there receiving or storage fees?

Yes. Please refer to the FedEx Office package handling and storage fee schedule included at the end of this packet.

Shipping questions

Katherine Dieudonne: katherine.dieudonne@fedex.com

Devon Muhleisen: devon.muhleisen@fedex.com

FedEx Office Business Center Hours

Monday–Friday	7:00 AM–7:00 PM
Saturday	8:00 AM–3:00 PM
Sunday	10:00 AM–5:00 PM

Vendor Setup, Booths & On-Site Details

Setup & Teardown

Access begins	Thursday, October 15 at 10:00 AM
Setup	Thursday, October 15 10:00 AM–5:00 PM
Teardown	Saturday, October 17 after 3:00 PM
Hotel setup assistance	Not provided
Return shipping	See the FedEx Office Shipping Instructions at the end of this packet

Vendor Booth Details

What is included with my vendor space?

One 6' x 30" table, tablecover and 3 chairs

Will Wi-Fi and power be available?

Basic Wi-Fi and power are available upon request. Please bring extension cords.

To order power and wifi: https://eventnow.encoreglobal.com/myevents/result/index/show_id/6550cfa6-4897-f111-8076-7ced8d22bb44/

Can I bring additional signage or pop-up displays?

Yes, as long as everything stays within the footprint of your assigned space.

Are booth spaces assigned?

Yes. Booths will be pre-assigned and shared in advance.

Swag Bags

Each attendee will receive a LabFest swag bag. We encourage every vendor to bring a branded item to hand out when attendees visit your booth.

Meals & Group Activities

Vendor participation includes group activities and meals from October 15–17. Please refer to the event schedule for timing.

Thursday night

The Thursday evening event is a distillery tour at Seven Three distillery 🍷🍷

Friday night

The Friday evening event is masquerade-themed—bring your mask and your energy!

Communication, Marketing & Promotion

Vendor Contacts

Primary contact	Marybeth Starr
Phone	769-235-2780 or 816-914-7733 (text or call)
Event website	www.nolalabfest.com

Vendor HQ on www.nolalabfest.com

Access event resources and vendor marketing templates at:

Path	www.nolalabfest.com > Exhibitor HQ
Password	Labfest26

You'll also receive event updates and reminders through the NOLA LabFest app (noted at the beginning of this show kit)

Show Specials & Promotion

We'd love to help amplify your LabFest presence. Please plan for the following:

- Send your show specials to Marybeth one month before the event.
- Submit a 60-second commercial to be played during the show.
- Bring a flyer or handout for attendees.
- Bring a branded giveaway item for attendees to place in their LabFest bags after visiting your booth.
- Use the Vendor HQ marketing templates to promote NOLA LabFest on your social channels.

Vendor Commercial Video Specs

Maximum length	60 seconds
Format	MP4
Video codec	H.264
Resolution	1920 × 1080 (1080p)
Aspect ratio	16:9 landscape
Frame rate	30 fps preferred; 24 or 29.97 fps acceptable
Audio	None; video will be played without sound
File size	250 MB maximum
Orientation	Landscape only—no vertical or square videos
Delivery	Final, fully rendered video only; no Canva links, PowerPoints or project files
Deadline	September 15, 2026

Design for silent playback

All messaging must be understandable visually. Any spoken dialogue, voiceover or other important audio content should also appear on-screen as text or captions. Keep logos and important copy away from the outer 5% of the frame to protect against cropping or overscan.

Nowak/LabFest reserves the right to reject or request replacement of files that do not meet technical specifications or are not appropriate for display.

New Orleans Favorites

A few team picks and local stops if you have time to explore before or after LabFest.

Coffee & Classics

- PJ's Coffee — 300 Canal Street, inside the DoubleTree
- Café Du Monde — 800 Decatur Street
- Lucky Dog — hot dog carts throughout the city

Team Restaurant Picks

- Shawn's pick: Mandina's — 3800 Canal Street
- Brandi's pick: Mr. B's Bistro — 201 Royal Street
- Marybeth's pick: Pat O'Brien's — 718 St. Peter Street
- Brett's pick: Ruby Slipper — 204 Decatur Street
- Honorable mentions: Acme Oyster House, Katie's and Drago's

Sunday Brunch

- Muriel's Jazz Brunch — 801 Chartres Street (reservations usually recommended; nicer restaurant)
- Arnaud's Jazz Brunch — 813 Rue Bienville (reservations usually recommended; nicer restaurant)

- Ruby Slipper — 204 Decatur Street (casual)

Casino

- Harrah's — 8 Canal Street

Quick planning note

Popular New Orleans restaurants can book up quickly, especially for brunch. If you already know where you want to go, make reservations early.

FedEx Office Shipping Instructions

The FedEx Office location at Hilton Riverside New Orleans manages parcel operations for the hotel. If you are shipping booth materials directly to the property, use the receiving, labeling, pickup and storage instructions on the following pages.

Important

Schedule shipments to arrive 3–4 days before the event. Packages are subject to FedEx Office handling, delivery and storage fees. For detailed pricing and requirements, refer to the official FedEx Office pages that follow.



Hilton Riverside New Orleans Shipping Instructions

Preparing Your Shipment

FedEx Office is committed to providing you with an outstanding experience during your stay. All guest and event packages being shipped to the property must follow the address label standards (illustrated below) to prevent package routing delays. Please schedule your shipment(s) to arrive four days prior to the event start date to avoid additional storage fees. Use the name of the recipient who will be on-site to receive and sign for the package(s). Please do not address shipments using property employee names unless the items are specifically for their use (e.g., hotel specifications, rooming lists or signed documents); this includes arranging for deliveries to all areas on the property.

If a package has not been picked up by the recipient and no contact information is provided, the package will be returned to the sender, who will be responsible for all additional shipping fees. For more information on package retention, the Return to Sender process, or to schedule package deliveries, please contact the FedEx Office business center at 504.581.5892. Package deliveries should only be scheduled after the recipient has completed the check-in process.

Package Labeling Standards and FedEx Office Contact

(Guest Name) (Guest Cell Number)

c/o FedEx Office at Hilton Riverside New Orleans

2 Poydras Street

New Orleans, LA 70130

(Convention / Conference / Group / Event Name)

Box ____ of ____

FedEx Office Business Center

Hilton Riverside New Orleans

2 Poydras Street

New Orleans, LA 70130

Phone: 504.581.5892

Fax: 504.581.5896

Email: usa5670@fedex.com

Operating Hours

Mon.–Fri.: 7:00 a.m. - 7:00 p.m.

Saturday: 8:00 a.m. - 3:00 p.m.

Sunday: 10:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m.

Shipments With Special Requirements

Meeting and event planners, exhibitors and attendees are encouraged to contact FedEx Office with any specific questions in advance of shipping their items. If you have any special needs (e.g., refrigeration requirements, after-hours delivery requests or changes to your meeting dates or rooms), please work directly with your Event Manager, who will communicate these needs to FedEx Office in advance of your event.

On-Site Package Delivery

In most cases, FedEx Office will complete delivery or pickup of packages within the conference and meeting rooms, lobby area and guest suites, but please consult with a FedEx Office team member for specific delivery limitations that may exist. In cases where a drayage company or a meeting decorator is used, FedEx Office team members will work closely with those vendors for proper package routing and release items directly to those vendors if they are on the property when the shipments arrive. Any decorator or drayage packages requiring overnight storage by FedEx Office will be assessed a handling fee. If your meeting/event is being handled by a drayage company or decorator, please ensure your shipments are being sent directly to the drayage company's or decorator's specified address. Items that require extra handling, such as pallet/crate breakdown or build up, multiple pickup or delivery points, or collecting or disposing of packaging materials, will be assessed an additional fee of \$70.00 per hour with a minimum of \$35.00 for 30 minutes. This fee will be assessed for each FedEx Office team member dedicated to perform these additional services. Please note that FedEx Office team members cannot lend out any moving equipment, which includes pallet jacks, dollies and flatbed carts.

Package Delivery to Guest Suites/Meeting Rooms

In most cases, FedEx Office will complete delivery or pickup of packages to guest suites, but please consult with a FedEx Office team member for any specific delivery limitations that may exist. FedEx Office is not authorized to leave packages unattended in guest suites and/or meeting rooms. A guest with authorization to sign for the delivery and approve any charges for handling and delivery fees must be present in guest rooms and/or meeting rooms.



Hilton Riverside New Orleans Shipping Instructions

Upon Your Arrival

Packages will be available for pickup at the FedEx Office business center; a handling fee will apply. Packages, pallets, crates, display cases and other heavier items may be scheduled for delivery by contacting our staff at 504.581.5892 a delivery fee will apply. Package deliveries should only be scheduled after the recipient has completed the check-in process. In order to maintain the proper chain of custody, FedEx Office requires the package recipient's signature before a package can be released from FedEx Office. Release signatures are captured at the time of package pickup or package delivery to the recipient.

Upon Your Departure

FedEx Office offers pack and ship services and packaging supplies, such as boxes, tape, etc., which are also available for purchase at the FedEx Office business center. All outbound packages must have a completed carrier airbill affixed to each package. FedEx Express® shipping boxes and airbill forms are available and are complimentary. Outbound packages and freight to be picked up by a third-party courier should be coordinated directly with those vendors, and communication should be sent to FedEx Office indicating when those items will be picked up. FedEx Office will not make arrangements for freight or third-party courier transportation and/or pickup. Outbound handling fees will be applied to all packages and freight, regardless of carrier, in addition to shipping/transportation fees.

Package Handling and Storage Fees

Package weight	Package pickup or dropoff by guest	Package pickup or delivery by FedEx Office
Envelopes up to 1.0 lb.	\$4.00	\$7.00
0.0–1.0 lb.	\$4.00	\$7.00
1.1–10.0 lbs.	\$10.00	\$15.00
10.1–20.0 lbs.	\$15.00	\$20.00
20.1–30.0 lbs.	\$25.00	\$30.00
30.1–40.0 lbs.	\$30.00	\$36.00
40.1–50.0 lbs.	\$35.00	\$42.00
50.1–60.0 lbs.	\$40.00	\$50.00
60.1–150.0 lbs.	\$55.00	\$66.00
Pallets & crates*	–	\$250.00 or \$0.80/lb. > 312 lbs.

Package weights will be rounded up to the nearest pound.

*For inbound/outbound pallets or crates, the receiving and delivery charges are consolidated into a single fee of \$250.00 or \$0.80/lb. > 312 lbs., which is applied to each pallet/crate handled.

Package weight	Storage fee after 5 days
Envelopes up to 1.0 lb.	No charge
0.0–10.0 lbs.	\$5.00
10.1–30.0 lbs.	\$10.00
30.1–60.0 lbs.	\$15.00
60.1–150.0 lbs.	\$25.00
Pallets & crates	\$50.00
Over 6.5' in size	\$25.00

A one-time package storage fee will apply to each package received and stored for more than five (5) calendar days. Items measuring over 6.5 feet in size are considered oversize and will be assessed an additional oversize fee if stored for more than five (5) calendar days.

Additional Services

Items that require extra handling, such as pallet/crate breakdown or build up, multiple pickup or delivery points, or collecting and disposing of packaging materials, will be assessed an additional fee of \$70.00 per hour with a minimum of \$35.00 for 30 minutes. This fee will be assessed for each FedEx Office team member dedicated to perform these additional services. Please note that FedEx Office team members cannot lend out any moving equipment, which includes pallet jacks, dollies, and flatbed carts.

Terms and Conditions

Receiving, delivery and storage charges are payable at the time of delivery. Recipient may be required to present government-issued photo identification and sign for delivery. Shipper must comply with all applicable local, state and federal laws, including those governing packing, marking, labeling and shipping. OBTAIN FIRE, CASUALTY AND ALL OTHER INSURANCE ON PACKAGE CONTENTS PRIOR TO SHIPPING. Neither the Property nor FedEx Office and Print Services, Inc. provide such insurance. Neither the Property nor FedEx Office and Print Services, Inc. nor the employees, agents or contractors of either firm will be liable for any damages, whether direct or indirect damages, relating to or arising out of any loss or damage to any package or its contents, unless a package is lost after receipt on the Property, in which case such liability shall be limited to the lesser of \$100 or the liability of the carrier indicated above. By sending your package to the Property, you agree to be bound by any additional terms and conditions that the Property or FedEx Office and Print Services, Inc. may establish from time to time for receiving and delivering of packages.

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